- Wipe up spills immediately.
- Separate raw meat and poultry from other items whenever you use or store them.
- Wash your hands before handling food and after handling meat or poultry.
- Get a fire extinguisher for the kitchen.

Follow these steps to keep cuts clean and prevent infections and scars.

- **Wash your hands.** First, wash up with soap and water so you don't get bacteria into the cut and cause an infection. If you're on the go, use hand sanitizer.
- **Stop the bleeding.** Put pressure on the cut with a gauze pad or clean cloth. Keep the pressure on for a few minutes.
- **Clean the wound.** Once you've stopped the bleeding, rinse the cut under cool running water or use a saline wound wash. Clean the area around the wound with soap and a wet washcloth. Don't get soap in the cut, because it can irritate the skin. And don't use hydrogen peroxide or iodine, which could irritate the cut.
- **Remove any dirt or debris.** Use a pair of tweezers cleaned with alcohol to gently pick out any dirt, gravel, glass, or other material in the cut.

Generally a good antiseptic cream (silverex or burnol) should be kept handy. It is advisable to have a small first aid kit readily available in the kitchen.

FIRST AID BOX CONTENTS

First aid manual	Syringes
Band aid	Guaze (different sizes)
Scissors (small)	Thermometer
Lotion	Contact lenses
Roll Bandages	Gloves
Antiseptic wipes	

▲ Fig 6 Contents of a First Aid Box

DO YOU KNOW?

Alloxen, a byproduct of bleaching white flour which is often found in junk food, leads to diabetes by destroying pancreatic beta cells

SUMMARY

1. Having learnt about the functions of food, the different food groups and their nutrients, one would understand the importance of a balanced diet and would also be able to plan a balanced diet from the locally available foods .
2. Knowledge of the different methods of cooking along with their merits and demerits enables one to choose the best method of cooking for any given food, so as to ensure the availability of maximum nutrients .
3. A study on the different kitchen equipment and appliances helps in familiarizing the same. The chapter also throws light on simple first aid measures and different methods of improving the nutritional quality of common foods like cereals and legumes.

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